

# PRACTICAL 1 - LINEAR (MIXED) MODELS

In this practical we are going to fit linear (mixed) models in `inlabru`. We are going to to:

- Fit a **simple linear regression**
- Fit a **linear regression with discrete covariates and interactions**
- Fit a **linear mixed model**.
- **Compare models using DIC and WAIC**

## Note

You can download the R-script of this practical by clicking the button below:

Start by loading useful libraries:

```
library(INLA)
library(patchwork)
library(inlabru)
library(car)
library(tidyverse)
# load some libraries to generate nice plots
library(scico)
```

At the end of this exercise we are going to compare the different models we fit using DIC and WAIC. Therefore we need to tell the `bru()` function to compute those scores, we can do that by the `bru_options_set()` functions:

```
bru_options_set(control.compute = list(dic = T, waic = T))
```

This is a global option that will make `bru()` compute scores everytime. It is also possible to set the option locally as

```
fit = bru(cmp, lik,
          options = list(control.compute = list(dic = TRUE)))
```

## 1 Simple linear regression

We consider a simple linear regression model with Gaussian observations

$$y_i \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu_i, \sigma^2), \quad i = 1, \dots, N$$

where  $\sigma^2$  is the observation error, and the mean parameter  $\mu_i$  is linked to the **linear predictor** ( $\eta_i$ ) through an identity function:

$$\eta_i = \mu_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x_i.$$

Here  $\mathbf{x} = (x_1, \dots, x_N)$  is a continuous covariate and  $\beta_0, \beta_1$  are parameters to be estimated.

To finalize the Bayesian model we assign prior distribution as  $\tau = 1/\sigma^2 \sim \text{Gamma}(a, b)$  and  $\beta_0, \beta_1 \sim \mathcal{N}(0, 1/\tau_\beta)$  (we will use the default prior settings in INLA for now).

#### Question

What is the dimension of the hyperparameter vector and latent Gaussian field?

Answer

The hyperparameter vector has dimension 1,  $\theta = (\tau)$  while the latent Gaussian field  $\mathbf{u} = (\beta_0, \beta_1)$  has dimension 2, 0 mean, and sparse precision matrix:

$$\mathbf{Q} = \begin{bmatrix} \tau_{\beta_0} & 0 \\ 0 & \tau_{\beta_1} \end{bmatrix}$$

Note that, since  $\beta_0$  and  $\beta_1$  are fixed effects, the precision parameters  $\tau_{\beta_0}$  and  $\tau_{\beta_1}$  are fixed.

#### Note

We can write the linear predictor vector  $\boldsymbol{\eta} = (\eta_1, \dots, \eta_N)$  as

$$\boldsymbol{\eta} = \mathbf{A}\mathbf{u} = \mathbf{A}_1\mathbf{u}_1 + \mathbf{A}_2\mathbf{u}_2 = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ \vdots \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \beta_0 + \begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \\ \vdots \\ x_N \end{bmatrix} \beta_1$$

Our linear predictor consists then of two components: an intercept and a slope.

## 2 Modelling penguins bodymass

Let's look at the dataset penguins in R.

These are data on adult penguins covering three species found on three islands in the Palmer Archipelago, Antarctica, including their size (flipper length, body mass, bill dimensions), and sex.

```
data("penguins")
glimpse(penguins)
```

```
Rows: 344
Columns: 8
$ species    <fct> Adelie, Adelie, Adelie, Adelie, Adelie, Adelie, Adelie, Ad~
$ island     <fct> Torgersen, Torgersen, Torgersen, Torgersen, Torgersen, Tor~
$ bill_len   <dbl> 39.1, 39.5, 40.3, NA, 36.7, 39.3, 38.9, 39.2, 34.1, 42.0, ~
$ bill_dep   <dbl> 18.7, 17.4, 18.0, NA, 19.3, 20.6, 17.8, 19.6, 18.1, 20.2, ~
$ flipper_len <int> 181, 186, 195, NA, 193, 190, 181, 195, 193, 190, 186, 180, ~
$ body_mass  <int> 3750, 3800, 3250, NA, 3450, 3650, 3625, 4675, 3475, 4250, ~
$ sex        <fct> male, female, female, NA, female, male, female, male, NA, ~
$ year       <int> 2007, 2007, 2007, 2007, 2007, 2007, 2007, 2007, 2007, 2007~
```

The dataset contains the following variables:

**species** a factor denoting penguin species (Adélie, Chinstrap and Gentoo)

**island** a factor denoting island in Palmer Archipelago, Antarctica (Biscoe, Dream or Torgersen)

**bill\_length** a number denoting bill length (millimeters)

**bill\_depth\_mm** a number denoting bill depth (millimeters)

**flipper\_length** an integer denoting flipper length (millimeters)

**body\_mass** an integer denoting body mass (grams)

**sex** a factor denoting penguin sex (female, male)

**year** and integer indicating the study year: (2007, 2008, 2009)

We are going to use the bodymass as our response variable. To make the interpretation easier we are going to express the bodymass in Kg instead of grams.

```
penguins$body_mass = penguins$body_mass/1000
```

## 2 Fitting a linear regression model with inlabru

In a first step we want to fit a simple linear regression model to link the body mass (body\_mass) to flipper length (flipper\_len).

$$y_i \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu_i, \sigma_y^2)$$

$$\mu_i = \beta_0 + \beta_i x_i$$

where  $y_i$  indicates the body mass and  $x_i$  the flipper length of penguin  $i$ .

### Step1: Defining model components

The first step is to define the two model components: The intercept and the linear covariate effect.

#### Task

Define an object called `cmp` that includes and (i) intercept `beta_0` and (ii) and a linear effect `beta_1` of the `flipper_len`.

Take hint

The `cmp` object is here used to define model components. We can give them any useful names we like, in this case, `beta_0` and `beta_1`. You can remove the automatic intercept construction by adding a `-1` in the components

[Click here to see the solution](#)

```
cmp = ~ -1 + beta_0(1) + beta_1(flipper_len, model = "linear")
```

#### i Note

Note that we have excluded the default Intercept term in the model by typing `-1` in the model components. However, `inlabru` has automatic intercept that can be called by typing `Intercept()`, which is one of `inlabru` special names and it is used to define a global intercept, e.g.

```
cmp = ~ Intercept(1) + beta_1(flipper_len, model = "linear")
```

another way to code this model would be to use the `model = "fixed"`. In this case we would define the components as:

```
cmp = ~ -1 + effects(~ flipper_len, model = "fixed")
```

**NOTE** In the following we are going to use this last way of defining the components!

## Step 2: Build the observation model

The next step is to construct the observation model by defining the model likelihood. The most important inputs here are the formula, the family and the data.

### Task

Define a linear predictor `eta` using the component labels you have defined on the previous task.

Take hint

The `eta` object defines how the components should be combined in order to define the model predictor.

[Click here to see the solution](#)

```
formula = body_mass ~ effects
```

The likelihood for the observational model is defined using the `bru_obs()` function.

### Task

Define the observational model likelihood in an object called `lik` using the `bru_obs()` function.

Take hint

The `bru_obs` is expecting three arguments:

- The linear predictor `eta` we defined in the previous task
- The data likelihood (this can be specified by setting `family = "gaussian"`)
- The data set `df`

[Click here to see the solution](#)

```
lik = bru_obs(formula = formula,
              data = penguins,
              family = "gaussian")
```

## Step 3: Fit the model

We fit the model using the `bru()` functions which takes as input the components and the observation model:

```
fit1 = bru(cmp, lik)
```

**NOTE** running the code above we are going to get an *error* !!

This error is linked to the fact that, when using `model = "fixed"` the default option for `model.matrix()` is to remove all lines with NAs.

NAs are not a problem in `inlabru` they just don't make any contribution to the likelihood....but matrix of the wrong dimension are :smile:.

To avoid this we can tell R to keep all missing values as follows:

```
options(na.action = 'na.pass')
fit1 = bru(cmp, lik)
```

#### Step 4: Extract results

There are several ways to extract and examine the results of a fitted `inlabru` object.

The most natural place to start is to use the `summary()` which gives access to some basic information about model fit and estimates

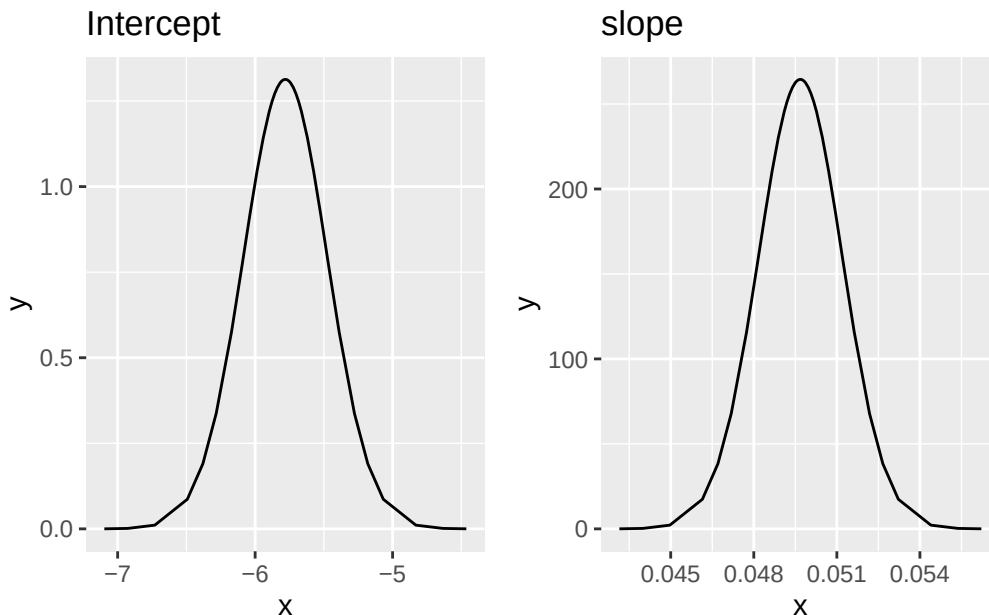
```
summary(fit1)
## inlabru version: 2.14.0.9003
## INLA version: 25.09.04
## Latent components:
## effects: main = fixed(~flipper_len)
## Observation models:
##   Model tag: <No tag>
##   Family: 'gaussian'
##   Data class: 'data.frame'
##   Response class: 'numeric'
##   Predictor: body_mass ~ effects
##   Additive/Linear/Rowwise: TRUE/TRUE/TRUE
##   Used components: effect[effects], latent[]
## Time used:
##   Pre = 1.13, Running = 0.332, Post = 0.0298, Total = 1.5
## Random effects:
##   Name      Model
##   effects IID model
##
## Model hyperparameters:
##                                     mean      sd 0.025quant 0.5quant
## Precision for the Gaussian observations 6.47 0.495      5.54      6.46
##                                     0.975quant mode
## Precision for the Gaussian observations      7.48 6.43
##
## Deviance Information Criterion (DIC) .....: 337.94
## Deviance Information Criterion (DIC, saturated) ....: 347.38
## Effective number of parameters .....: 2.99
##
## Watanabe-Akaike information criterion (WAIC) ...: 337.90
## Effective number of parameters .....: 2.92
##
## Marginal log-Likelihood: -192.93
## is computed
## Posterior summaries for the linear predictor and the fitted values are computed
## (Posterior marginals needs also 'control.compute=list(return.marginals.predictor=TRUE)')
```

## Task

Plot the posterior marginals for the estimated intercept and slope

[Click here to see the solution](#)

```
p1 = fit1$marginals.random$effects$index.1 %>% ggplot() + geom_line(aes(x,y)) + ggtitle("I")
p2 = fit1$marginals.random$effects$index.2 %>% ggplot() + geom_line(aes(x,y)) + ggtitle("s")
p1 + p2
```



Another way, which gives access to more complicated (and useful) output is to use the `predict()` function.

Below we take the fitted `bru` object and use the `predict()` function to produce predictions for  $\eta$  given a new set of values for the years of service

```
new_data = data.frame(flipper_len = 170:240)
pred = predict(fit1, new_data, ~ effects,
               n.samples = 1000)
```

The `predict()` function generate samples from the fitted model and then summarizes those samples by computing some statistics like posterior mean, standard deviation, quantiles etc. In this case we set the number of samples to 1000.

We can plot the predictions for  $\eta$  together with the observed data:

### 3 Plot

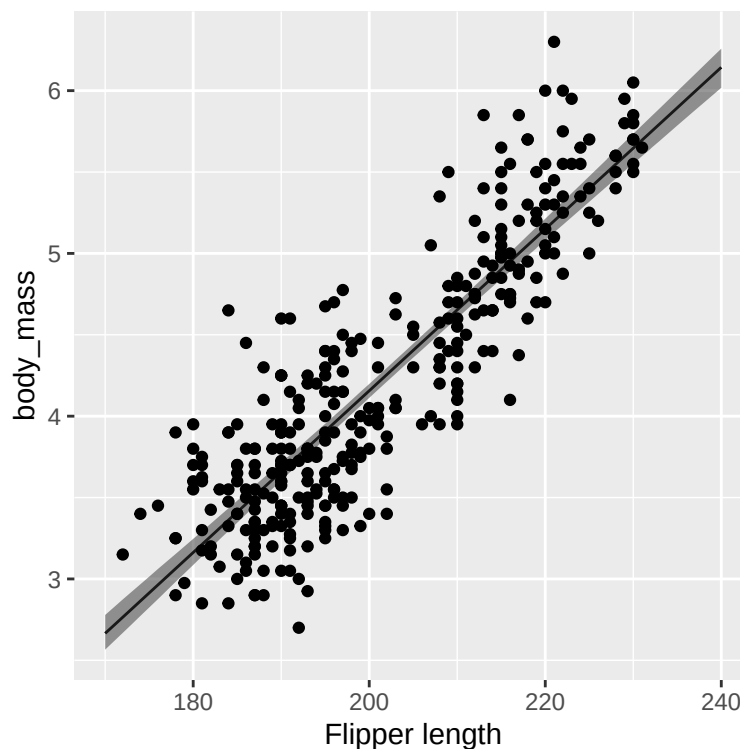


Figure 1: Data and 95% credible intervals

**NOTE:** The uncertainty we have computed now is relative to the prediction of  $\eta$ . If we want to predict new body mass, we need to add the observation (likelihood) uncertainty  $\sigma_y^2$ . We can do this using `predict()` again:

```
new_data = data.frame(flipper_len = 170:240)

pred1 = predict(fit1, new_data,
  formula = ~ { eta = effects
    sigma = sqrt(1/Precision_for_the_Gaussian_observations)
    list(mean = eta,
      q1 = qnorm(0.025, mean = eta, sd = sigma),
      q2 = qnorm(0.975, mean = eta, sd = sigma))
    },
  n.samples = 1000)
```

Let's compare the two predictions:

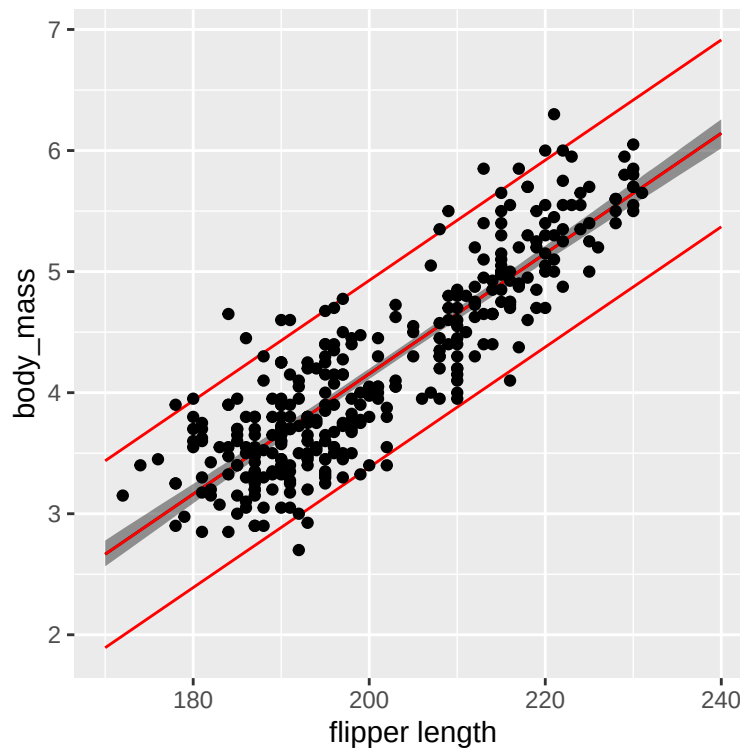


Figure 2: Data and 95% credible intervals

#### Task

Use the function `generate()` to create a sample of 100 possible regression lines from the fitted model

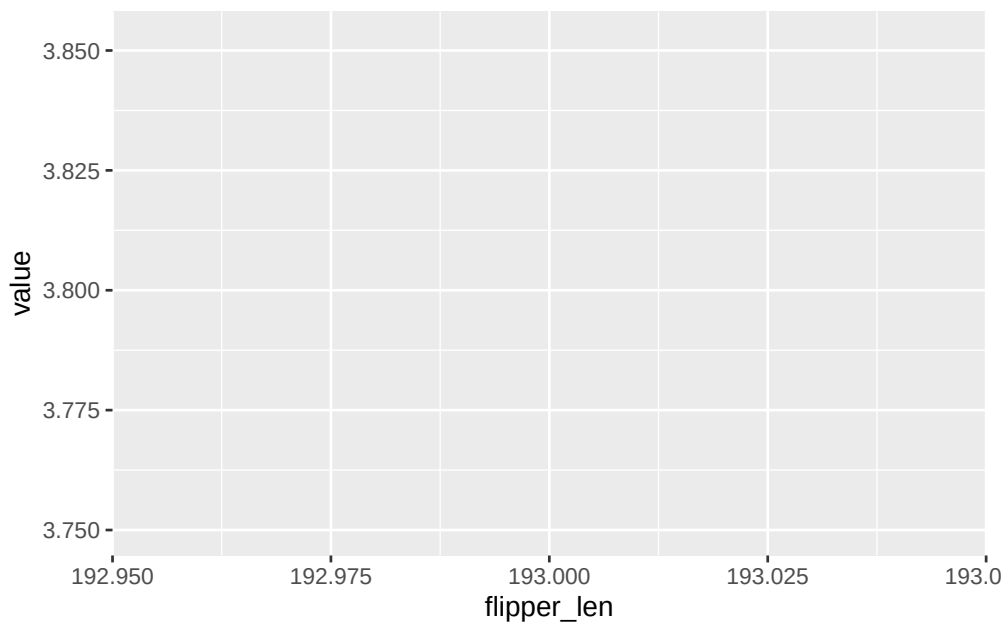
[Click here to see the solution](#)

```
new_data = data.frame(flipper_len = 193)
gen = generate(fit1, new_data, ~ effects,
              n.samples = 100)

data.frame(flipper_len = new_data$flipper_len,
            gen) %>%
  pivot_longer(-flipper_len) %>%
  ggplot() + geom_line(aes(flipper_len, value, group = name))
```

``geom_line()``: Each group consists of only one observation.  
i Do you need to adjust the group aesthetic?





### Task

Generate predictions for the mean body mass  $\eta$  when the flipper length is  $x_0 = 193$  mm

What is the predicted value for  $\eta$ ? And what is the uncertainty?

Take hint

You can create a new data frame containing the new observation  $x_0$  and then use the `predict` function.

[Click here to see the solution](#)

```
new_data = data.frame(flipper_len = 193)
pred = predict(fit1, new_data, ~ effects,
               n.samples = 1000)
```

```
pred
```

```
flipper_len    mean      sd  q0.025    q0.5  q0.975  median
1          193 3.807351 0.02498044 3.755289 3.807301 3.855281 3.807301
mean.mc_std_err sd.mc_std_err
1    0.0008266016 0.0005794986
```

You can see the predicted mean and sd by examining the produced `pred` object. In this case the mean is ca 4 kg with sd ca 0.02. This gives a 95% CI ca [3.76, 3.86].

**NOTE** Now we have produced a credible interval for the expected mean  $\eta$  if we want to produce a *prediction* interval for a new observation  $y$  we need to add the uncertainty that comes from the likelihood with precision  $\tau = 1/\sigma_y^2$ . To do this we can again use the `predict()` function to compute a 95% prediction interval for  $y$ .

```
pred2 = predict(fit1, new_data,
                formula = ~ {
                  mu = effects
                  sigma = sqrt(1/Precision_for_the_Gaussian_observations)
                  list(q1 = qnorm(0.025, mean = mu, sd = sigma),
```

```

      q2 = qnorm(0.975, mean = mu, sd = sigma)}},
    n.samples = 1000)
round(c(pred2$q1$mean, pred2$q2$mean), 2)

```

```
[1] 3.04 4.58
```

Notice that now the interval we obtain is much bigger! ahahah

## 4 Linear model with discrete variables and interactions

Now we want to check if there is any difference, both in mean body\_mass and in mean increase of the body\_mass with flipper length, between males and females

To do this we have to fit a model with interactions:

$$y_i \sim \mathcal{N}(\eta_i, \sigma_y^2)$$

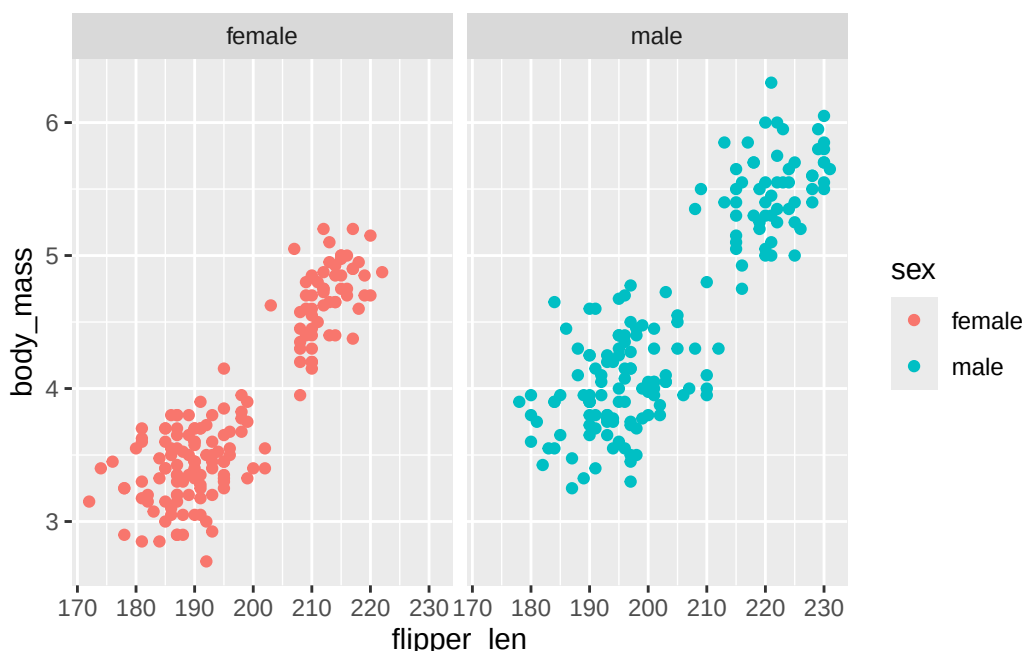
$$\eta_i = \beta_0 + \beta_{0,\text{Male}} + \beta_1 x_i + \beta_{1,\text{Male}} x_i$$

Let's first look at an explorative plot

```

penguins %>%
  filter(!is.na(sex)) %>%
  ggplot() + geom_point(aes(flipper_len, body_mass, color= sex)) +
  facet_wrap(~sex)

```



We fit the model using the `model = "fixed"` option.

```

cmp = ~ -1 + effects(~ sex*flipper_len, model = "fixed")
formula = body_mass ~ .
lik = bru_obs(formula = formula,

```

```
data = penguins
)
fit2 = bru(cmp, lik)
```

We can get the results looking at the `summary.random` object as follows:

```
fit2$summary.random
```

\$effects

|                       | ID            | mean          | sd           | 0.025quant    | 0.5quant |
|-----------------------|---------------|---------------|--------------|---------------|----------|
| 1 (Intercept)         | -5.2560419316 | 0.423683123   | -6.087343974 | -5.2560447991 |          |
| 2 sexmale             | 0.2188495010  | 0.575523535   | -0.910395715 | 0.2188524648  |          |
| 3 flipper_len         | 0.0462183314  | 0.002141407   | 0.042016627  | 0.0462183459  |          |
| 4 sexmale:flipper_len | 0.0006403378  | 0.002862713   | -0.004976558 | 0.0006403229  |          |
|                       | 0.975quant    | mode          | kld          |               |          |
| 1                     | -4.424723529  | -5.2560447955 | 5.442550e-10 |               |          |
| 2                     | 1.348077807   | 0.2188524611  | 5.440500e-10 |               |          |
| 3                     | 0.050419953   | 0.0462183459  | 5.442492e-10 |               |          |
| 4                     | 0.006257319   | 0.0006403229  | 5.440469e-10 |               |          |

#### Task

Use the `predict()` function to get an estimate of the mean increase of `body_mass` per mm of flipper length for males and females.

Would you conclude that there are differences between males and females?

Give me a hint

Since we are not interested in prediction but just on the parameters values, we can use the `_latent` suffix to get only the estimated parameters

[Click here to see the solution](#)

```
# Here we use the _latent "trick" to recover the parameters
# here we do not need any new data to predict for, we can use an
# empty data frame
```

```
params = predict(fit2, data.frame() , ~ data.frame( intercept_female = effects_latent[1],
                                                    intercept_male = effects_latent[1] + effects_
                                                    slope_female = effects_latent[3] ,
                                                    slope_male = effects_latent[3] + effects_late
```

Two things to notice here:

1. We have used an empty object as newdata in the `predict()` function.
2. The suffix `_latent` indicates that we are interested in the latent model effect.

#### Task

Use the `predict()` function again, this time to obtain the two regression lines.

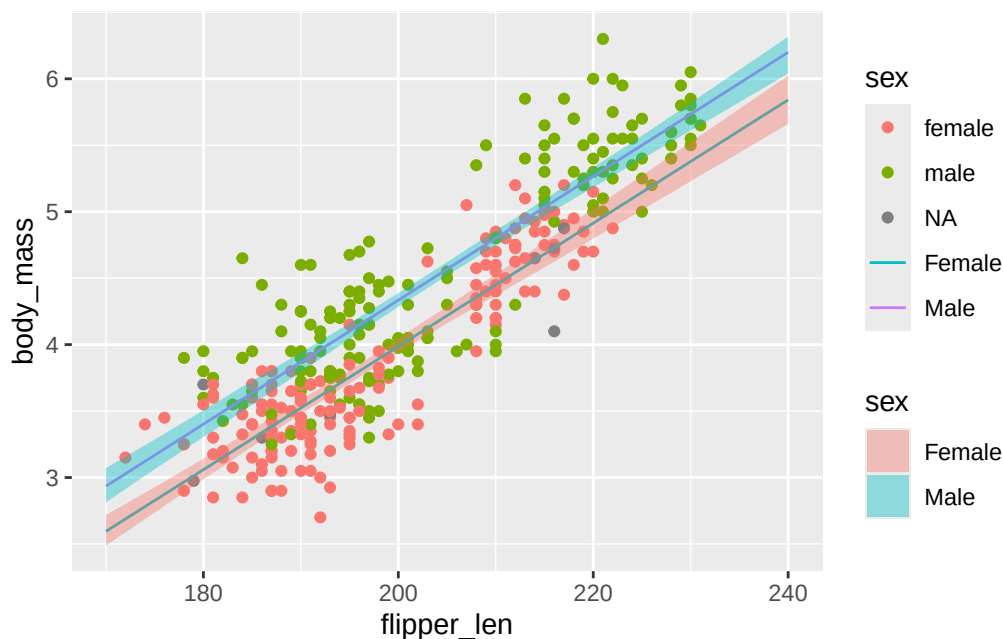
[Click here to see the solution](#)

```
new_data = data.frame(flipper_len = rep(170:240, 2),
                      sex = rep(c("Male", "Female"), each = 71))

pred = predict(fit2, new_data, ~ effects)

ggplot() + geom_point(data = penguins, aes(flipper_len, body_mass, color = sex)) +
  geom_line(data = pred, aes(flipper_len, mean, color = sex, group = sex)) +
  geom_ribbon(data = pred, aes(flipper_len, ymin = q0.025, ymax = q0.975, fill = sex, group = sex),
            alpha = 0.4)
```

Warning: Removed 2 rows containing missing values or values outside the scale range (`geom\_point()`).



Another way to fit this model is to realize that a fixed effect can be seen as an iid effect with fixed precision, one of the inlabru ways to fit the model is:

```
cmp = ~ -1 + sex_intercept(sex, model = "iid", initial = log(0.001), fixed = T) +
  sex_slope(sex, flipper_len, model = "iid", fixed = T, initial = log(0.001))
lik = bru_obs(formula = body_mass ~ .,
              data = penguins %>% filter(!is.na(sex)))
fit2b = bru(cmp, lik)
```

Notice that we fix the precision of the iid effect to the same value as the precision of the linear effects which is 0.001.

The fitted values can be inspected as

```
fit2b$summary.random$sex_intercept
```

|   | ID     | mean      | sd        | 0.025quant | 0.5quant  | 0.975quant | mode      |
|---|--------|-----------|-----------|------------|-----------|------------|-----------|
| 1 | female | -5.442907 | 0.4399825 | -6.306204  | -5.442910 | -4.579592  | -5.442910 |
| 2 | male   | -5.036399 | 0.3884276 | -5.798541  | -5.036401 | -4.274245  | -5.036401 |

```

      kld
1 5.835819e-10
2 5.837066e-10

```

```
fit2b$summary.random$sex_slope
```

```

      ID      mean      sd 0.025quant  0.5quant 0.975quant      mode
1 female 0.04714741 0.002224868 0.04278187 0.04714742 0.05151286 0.04714742
2  male 0.04685481 0.001894588 0.04313734 0.04685482 0.05057222 0.04685482
      kld
1 5.835806e-10
2 5.837520e-10

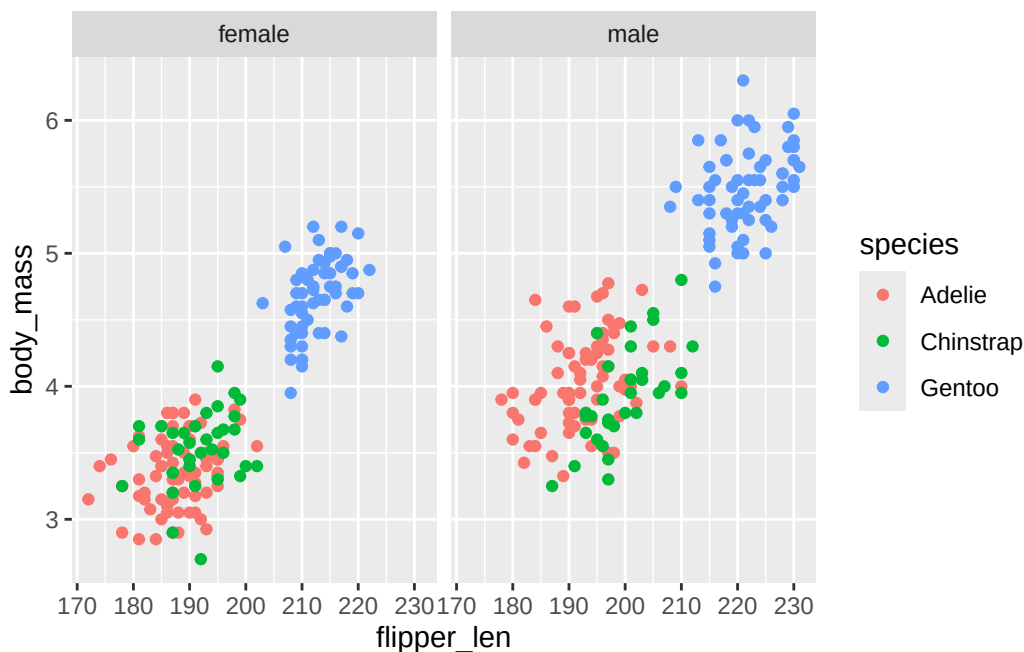
```

The results from the `fit2b` model is not the same we get from the `fit` model. What is happening? It is just a matter of parametrization.

You can go from one parametrization to the other by using the `predict()` function as we saw earlier

## 5 Linear Mixed Model

When looking at the data we see that there are differences in body mass depending on the species.



To account for this we introduce species as a random effect in the model.

### Task

Modify the code below to include an iid random effect for species:

```

cmp = ~ -1 + effects( ~ sex*flipper_len, model = "fixed") +
  species(species, ... )
formula = ...
lik = bru_obs(formula = formula,
              data = penguins
            )
fit3 = bru(cmp, lik)

```

[Click here to see the solution](#)

```

cmp = ~ -1 + effects( ~ sex*flipper_len, model = "fixed") +
  species(species, model = "iid")
formula = body_mass ~ .
lik = bru_obs(formula = formula,
              data = penguins
            )
fit3 = bru(cmp, lik)

```

We now look at the results for the fixed effects and compare with those from the previous model

```
fit3$summary.random$effects[,c(1,3,5)]
```

|   | ID                  | sd          | 0.5quant     |
|---|---------------------|-------------|--------------|
| 1 | (Intercept)         | 0.719605470 | 0.421084537  |
| 2 | sexmale             | 0.482491823 | -0.475714761 |
| 3 | flipper_len         | 0.003370555 | 0.017276758  |
| 4 | sexmale:flipper_len | 0.002412977 | 0.005011392  |

```
fit2$summary.random$effects[,c(1,3,5)]
```

|   | ID                  | sd          | 0.5quant      |
|---|---------------------|-------------|---------------|
| 1 | (Intercept)         | 0.423683123 | -5.2560447991 |
| 2 | sexmale             | 0.575523535 | 0.2188524648  |
| 3 | flipper_len         | 0.002141407 | 0.0462183459  |
| 4 | sexmale:flipper_len | 0.002862713 | 0.0006403229  |

#### Task

We want to include a random effect, dependent on species, also on the slope. Modify the code below to include that random effect.

```

cmp = ~ -1 + effects( ~ sex*flipper_len, model = "fixed") +
  species1(species, ... ) +
  species2(species, ... )
formula = ...
lik = bru_obs(formula = formula,
              data = penguins
              )
fit4 = bru(cmp, lik)

```

[Click here to see the solution](#)

```

cmp = ~ -1 + effects( ~ sex*flipper_len, model = "fixed") +
  species1(species, model = "iid") +
  species2(species, flipper_len, model = "iid")
formula = body_mass ~ .
lik = bru_obs(formula = formula,
              data = penguins
              )
fit4 = bru(cmp, lik)

```

## 6 Model comparison

As a by-product of the main computations `inlabru` can compute some scores that can be useful to compare models (we will talk more about this later in the course).

The easiest scores are the Deviance Information Criteria (DIC) and the Wakaike Information Criteria (WAIC).

These scores take into account goodness-of-fit and a penalty term that is based on the complexity of the model via the estimated effective number of parameters.

The lower the value of the score, the better the model is rated.

```

deltaIC(fit1, fit2, fit3, fit4, criterion = c("DIC","WAIC"))

```

Warning in `deltaIC(fit1, fit2, fit3, fit4, criterion = c("DIC", "WAIC"))`: WAIC values from INLA are not well-defined for point process models. Use with caution, or better, not at all. TRUE

|   | Model | DIC      | Delta.DIC  | WAIC     | Delta.WAIC |
|---|-------|----------|------------|----------|------------|
| 1 | fit4  | 147.3463 | 0.000000   | 147.1472 | 0.000000   |
| 2 | fit3  | 148.4950 | 1.148649   | 148.3034 | 1.156126   |
| 3 | fit2  | 272.9029 | 125.556587 | 272.6083 | 125.461029 |
| 4 | fit1  | 337.9389 | 190.592565 | 337.8981 | 190.750891 |